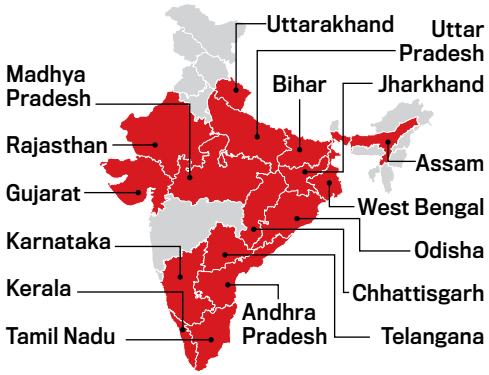
So what exactly is Sickle Cell Anaemia? Our red blood cells (RBCs) contain haemoglobin, which, in turn, carries oxygen to all parts of the body. Healthy RBCs are round in shape and pass through blood vessels easily. In SCA, the RBCs take on a 'C' shape resembling a sickle, hence the name sickle cell. The sickle-shaped cell is also sticky and does not pass easily through blood vessels, resulting in a general deficit in oxygen supply to various parts of the body. This, in turn, leads to pain and infarction in organs.

Treatment is largely based on pain management and precautions. The US national public health agency, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, says the only FDA-approved cure is a bone marrow transplant, which comes at great risk and is based on matches of donor and recipient. The FDA (Food and Drug Administration) has approved four treatments based

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GUJARAT

'VIBRANT GUJARAT' GOES GLOCAL

By Jumana Shah

The biennial Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit (VGGS) will be back next year after a four-year Covid-imposed hiatus. The high-profile international business gathering was conceptualised in 2003 to position Gujarat as a compelling investment destination. Returning in a high-stakes election year, the summit hopes to attract more than just external investors. It is also a quasi-political vehicle to showcase the government's achievements and business policies to its core vote bank—the middle-class traders and business communities.

The countdown to the event—scheduled between January 11 and 13 next year—has begun at the state industries department. In the coming months, a smaller version of the summit that happens in state capital Gandhinagar will be held in the industrial towns of north Gujarat, south Gujarat, central Gujarat and Saurashtra. Businessmen of the region will lead the delegations, accompanied by government officials. They will exhibit the potential business opportunities for sundry sectors, inviting investors to attend the big Gandhinagar event. The presentations will focus a great deal on government schemes and business infrastructure that can spur investments with the potential to generate employment—an issue raised by the Opposition Aam Aadmi Party and Congress ahead of the state polls. "Local industries and MSMEs (micro, small and medium-scale enterprises) have participated in the Vibrant Gujarat summits since the beginning, but mostly a few big business houses from urban areas. MSMEs don't see any immediate takeaway from the summit, but in the long run, there is immense benefit. We have seen that the benefits of big investments trickle down to the MSMEs," says Pathik Patwari, the immediate past president of the Gujarat Chamber of Commerce and Industry (GCCI).



SHOWCASING STATE
The Vibrant Gujarat summit in 2019 in Gandhinagar

Two decades ago, when Narendra Modi had just taken up the reins of Gujarat, his primary goal was to position the state as the most attractive investment region. He hosted top industrialists of the country and showcased Gujarat's infrastructure potential, coupled with its strategic strengths and policies. This later expanded to include countries as partners in the summit and hosting multiple heads of state over the years. Japan, Canada, Australia, the US and UK etc. have figured in the list of country-partners.